STRATEGY & ANALYTICS CASE

Loblaw Discount Division 2020 Performance Review

A 15-minute discussion on performance, priority opportunities, and immediate actions.

Prepared for

Strategy Manager discussion

Presented by: Krystal Ng

Context: Discount Division prior to Hard Discount

Date: June 2026

Source: Super Market Strategy & Analytics Case workbook; fictitious case data.

Agenda

A focused path from headline performance to recommended action.

1 **Executive takeaway**
How 2020 growth masked national share loss.

2 **Performance scorecard**
Sales, promo, e-commerce, and industry comparison.

3 **Priority focus areas**
Why Ontario/RCSS is the near-term priority and Atlantic is the playbook.

4 **Actions, KPIs, and Q&A**
Immediate workstreams, success measures, thank-you, and appendix backup.

Source: Super Market Strategy & Analytics Case workbook; fictitious case data.

Discount Division 2020: growth masked share loss

Recommended discussion: use 2020 momentum to defend value while closing regional and e-commerce gaps.

$25.4B

2020 sales

Sales grew 6.8%, but the market grew 11.0%.

17.3%

national share

Share declined -0.7 pts versus 2019.

4.6%

e-commerce penetration

E-commerce sales rose 207%, but penetration trails industry by 0.4 pts.

Recommendation: prioritize a share recovery program in Ontario/RCSS while scaling e-commerce capacity and preserving value-price credibility.

What management should take away

- The division captured absolute COVID-era demand, but lost relative position versus a faster-growing market.
- Ontario is the largest actionable issue: combined share fell about 1.0 pt and RCSS Ontario declined 9.6%.
- E-commerce was the biggest growth engine; closing the industry penetration gap is a near-term share lever.
- No Frills Atlantic is a small-base success case and should be mined for transferable execution lessons.

Source: Super Market Strategy & Analytics Case workbook; fictitious case data.

Scorecard: growth was strong, relative capture weaker

Core issue is not demand generation; it is relative capture of a growing market.

Sales growth

Net result: national share moved from 18.0% to 17.3%.

Change: -0.7 pts.

Metric	Discount	Industry
Sales growth	**6.8%**	**11.0%**
Promo penetration	**35.2%**	**35.2%**
E-com penetration	**4.6%**	**5.0%**
E-com sales growth	**207%**	**178%**

Interpretation

- Promo penetration matched the market in 2020 and declined versus 2019, so share recovery should not rely only on deeper blanket promotion.
- Every discount market hit peak e-commerce sales in WE Mar 14 20, indicating a capacity and fulfillment stress test during the demand spike.
- E-commerce penetration is already material at 4.6%; the issue is converting rapid adoption into sustainable market-share capture.

Source: Super Market Strategy & Analytics Case workbook; fictitious case data.

Focus areas: Ontario/RCSS priority; Atlantic playbook

Regional lens shows the largest value pool also contains the clearest share leak.

Region	2020 sales	YoY	Share	Share chg.	Readout
Atlantic	$0.4B	**38.4%**	4.6%	**+1.0 pts**	Small base, strong momentum; mine No Frills playbook.
Quebec	$3.3B	**6.6%**	15.5%	**-0.6 pts**	Maxi grew, but lagged market share capture.
Ontario	$7.7B	**2.9%**	12.2%	**-1.0 pts**	Largest problem: combined share down and RCSS -9.6%.
West	$14.0B	**8.4%**	26.2%	**-0.6 pts**	Largest base; protect share while pushing e-com.

Ontario detail

No Frills Ontario: 6.3% sales growth.

RCSS Ontario: -9.6% sales growth.

E-commerce lens

Division penetration: 4.6%; industry: 5.0%.

Treat e-commerce as a share lever, not only a channel KPI.

Source: Super Market Strategy & Analytics Case workbook; fictitious case data.

Immediate actions and KPIs

Breadth-first opportunity set for the leadership team; validate with store, customer, and margin detail.

1. Ontario share reset

- Deep dive RCSS Ontario stores, assortment, price gaps, and out-of-stock drivers.
- Localize value communication and traffic-driving categories where share loss is highest.
- KPI: weekly Ontario share, RCSS Ontario YoY sales, traffic, and basket size.

2. E-commerce capacity

- Expand pickup/delivery slot availability around high-demand stores and peak weeks.
- Improve substitution quality and availability on known online baskets.
- KPI: e-com penetration gap to industry, fulfillment rate, repeat online shoppers.

3. Value and promo discipline

- Protect key value items and sharpen promo where competitive gaps are visible.
- Shift from blanket depth to targeted, margin-aware offers by market and trip mission.
- KPI: price index, promo ROI, gross margin mix, customer retention.

4. Scale what works

- Study No Frills Atlantic growth drivers: local execution, offer, labor model, and competitive context.
- Replicate transferable practices in comparable smaller-base markets.
- KPI: market-specific share lift, sales per store, and execution scorecards.

Next data cuts: store-count normalization, margin, price index, loyalty cohorts, online capacity, and competitor density.

Source: Super Market Strategy & Analytics Case workbook; fictitious case data.

Thank you

Discussion prompts: Which Ontario diagnostic should we prioritize first? What e-commerce constraint is most urgent? What additional data would most change the recommendation?

Questions & discussion

Source: Super Market Strategy & Analytics Case workbook; fictitious case data.

Appendix: supporting analysis files

Use these files to validate the story, answer SQL questions, and reproduce the deck.

Supporting file	What it highlights
supporting_analysis.md	Assumptions, key outputs, regional scorecard, and SQL numeric answers.
metric_summary.csv	KPI summary by division, banner, region, and industry market.
sql_task_answers.sql	SQL logic for the five case questions and workbook-derived outputs.
super_market_strategy_analytics_case.xlsx	Downloaded source workbook used for all calculations.
build_loblaw_case_outputs.py	Reproducible generator for the PDF, HTML, notes, and appendices.

Analysis notes

- Division row used to avoid double-counting banner rows.
- Recommendations are directional because margin, store-count, price-index, and customer-level data are not included.

Source: Super Market Strategy & Analytics Case workbook; fictitious case data.